

LOCAL SPORTS

Comets find consolation

Top Midview for third place in DiFranco Memorial

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — Midview played the gracious host for its first annual Bob DiFranco Memorial Holiday Tournament.

But Middies coach Troy DiFranco didn't want his team to be quite this gracious.

Midview's varsity and junior varsity teams lost all four of the games they played in the tournament, including the varsity's 47-42 loss to Amherst in a consolation game Saturday night.

"I didn't think it was supposed to be that way," DiFranco said.

The tournament is named after Troy DiFranco's late father, a widely respected coach, teacher, and friend of area athletes for many years.

Amherst improved its record to 3-4 with the hard-fought consolation win while the Middies slipped to 3-6.

The teams staged an entertaining game, with the lead changing hands six times with two ties.

Amherst's biggest lead was 20-9 three minutes into the second quarter, but Midview battled back to take a 27-25 advantage on a 3-pointer by Aaron Fox with 3:47 to play in the third. From that point, the game remained tight until Amherst managed to

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hit five of six free throws down the stretch to win by the final margin.

Both Troy DiFranco and Amherst coach Mitch Gillam saw some improvement from Thursday's opening round of the tournament.

The Middies have seen more presses lately than a dry cleaner on a busy weekend but they handled the ball much better Saturday.

"I don't know what we ended up with but I know it wasn't the 28-30 turnovers we had against Westlake (last week), or Vermilion (Thursday)" said DiFranco. "We knew they were going to come out after us. (Amherst) saw the Vermilion game. I think we made some strides tonight even though we lost."

Midview had just 12 turnovers against the Comets.

Gillam was much more pleased Saturday as well.

"We played a little bit more within ourselves," Gillam said when asked the difference between his team's play Thursday and Saturday. "We didn't shoot ourselves in the foot. We played with a little more sense of

calm."

Amherst had also been turning the ball over at an alarming rate in its past three games, but the Comets did a much better job taking care of the ball Saturday.

"The last four games, we've had 23 to 30 turnovers in all those games," Gillam said. "The majority of those were unforced — just us making bad decisions. We talked about that with the guys after the (North Ridgeville) game the other night. We've been talking about it for weeks. We worked on it yesterday in practice."

It paid off. Amherst had only 10 turnovers against the Middies — just one the final quarter when the Comets salted the victory away behind 6-foot-5 senior Kyle Karpinski.

Karpinski practically took over the game to begin the fourth quarter. He blocked two shots and scored eight of his game-high 16 in the period.

"We wanted to come out and not let (Zack) Crowther or Karpinski beat us," said DiFranco. "You have to give credit to them. (Bryan Frank) really stepped up in the first half. You have to tip your hat to them. They made the shots."

Midview held Crowther without a field goal but Amherst got

big lifts from its two sophomores recently promoted to the varsity. Bryan Frank and Jason Knipp combined for 17 points — Frank getting 11, including three 3-point baskets.

"That's only (Frank's) his second varsity game," Gillam said. "He played an outstanding game for us. He's a competitive kid. He has a nice shot. We had a nice team effort."

"We've redefined our goals. We're just going to try to get better each game, each week. Our main goal is just to try to improve."

Fox and Ryan Feierabend led Midview's scoring with 12 points each. Drew Illner added 11 but the Middies got only seven other points. Feierabend grabbed 10 rebounds for the Middies but his teammates could come up with only a half-dozen others.

MIDVIEW (42): Illner 5-0-11, Fox 4-1-12, Feierabend 6-0-12, O'Donnell 0-0-0, Grimm 0-0-0, Trenchard 1-0-3, DiFranco 2-0-4, Schmidt 0-0-0, Krastienko 0-0-0, Schaefer 0-0-0. Totals 18-47.
AMHERST (47): Frank 4-0-11, Knipp 2-1-6, Quaranto 1-2-5, Mihalic 0-0-0, Madison 2-0-4, Crowther 0-3-3, Karpinski 7-2-16, McCall 1-0-2, Garcia 0-0-0, Hamel 0-0-0. Totals 17-47.
Score By Quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Midview	9	11	12	10	42
Amherst	11	11	11	14	47

Three-point goals: (M) Fox 3, Illner, Trenchard (A) Frank 3, Quaranto, Knipp. **Rebounds:** Midview 16 (Feierabend 10), Amherst 24 (Karpinski and Crowther 5). **Turnovers:** Midview 12, Amherst 10. **Fouled Out:** None. **Team Fouls:** (M) 14, (A) 12. **Junior Varsity:** Championship—Amherst 39, Vermilion 24. **Consolation—**North Ridgeville 48, Midview 26.

Clippers trimmed

by New London

NEW LONDON — Clearview slipped to 4-5 on the season by dropping a 61-55 non-conference game to New London Saturday.

Arrington Noble and Cleon Elliott reached double digits for the Clippers with 11 and 10 points respectively. Luke Jackson led New London (2-4) with 15 points.

CLEARVIEW (55): Noble 5-0-11, Elliott 4-0-10, Spaley 4-0-8, Kidd 3-0-7, Thomas 2-0-4, Ruiz 2-1-5, Thomas 2-0-4, Peluso 3-0-6. Totals 25-1-55.
NEW LONDON (61): Savage 3-3-10, J. Hamilton 5-1-12, H. Hamilton 0-0-9, Jackson 6-3-15, Thomas 1-1-3, C. Hamilton 3-0-6, Evans 1-0-2. Totals 22-12-41.

Clearview	15	13	14	—	55
New London	14	15	14	—	61

Three-point goals: Clearview 4 (Elliott 2, Noble, Kidd), New London 5 (H. Hamilton 3, Savage, J. Hamilton).

Westerville S. 71, Olm. Falls 62

WESTERVILLE — Olmsted Falls, despite a 33-15 fourth quarter and 30 points from Mike Gansey, lost the consolation game of the Westerville Classic.

Falls (3-3) trailed 56-29 after three quarters.

OLMSTED FALLS (62): M. Gansey 11-7-30, Buggoli 0-2-2, Stanton 5-2-15, Flores 1-0-2, Saluja 3-0-6, S. Gansey 2-1-5, Arcun 1-0-2. Totals 24-12-62.
WESTERVILLE SOUTH (71): Peoples 7-2-19, Teter 4-0-8, Moore 4-3-12, Burcher 2-0-4, Odum 3-0-6, Borgegard 2-0-4, Coleman 3-4-10, Skiver 4-0-8. Totals 29-9-71.

Olmsted Falls	9	12	8	33	—	62
Westerville South	20	14	22	15	—	71

Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls 2 (M. Gansey, Stanton).

BOYS BASKETBALL

Friday night

Worthington Chr. 82, Olm. Falls 73

WESTERVILLE — Mike Gansey's 35 points weren't enough as Olmsted Falls lost to Worthington Christian in the opening round of the Westerville Classic Friday night.

OLMSTED FALLS (73): Gansey 15-2-35, Binggoli 1-2-4, Mucha 1-1-3, Bradrick 1-2-4, Turbreek 2-0-4, Stanton 4-0-9, Flores 3-0-6, Saluja 3-1-8. Totals 30-8-73.
WORTHINGTON CHRISTIAN (82): Hadley 11-9-34, Gansey 1-0-2, Short 1-0-3, Switzer 3-0-7, Penn 4-1-10, Easley 2-3-8, Gray 5-1-13, Coldren 0-5-5. Totals 27-18-82.

Olmsted Falls	28	14	13	18	—	73
Worthington Chr.	14	30	19	18	—	82

Three-point goals: (OF) Gansey 3, Saluja, Stanton, (WC) Hadley 3, Gray 2, Easley Penn, Short, Switzer.

Brookside 93, Cle. Christian 41

RICHMOND HEIGHTS — Mark Reigelman led five players in double figures with 21 points as Brookside (2-5) sailed to victory in the consolation game of the Richmond Heights Tournament on Friday.

CLEVELAND CHRISTIAN ACADEMY (41): DeJesus 1-0-3, Smith 5-0-10, Fonseca 0-1-1, Perkins 7-0-16. Totals 18-1-41.
BROOKSIDE (93): Kuhnke 3-3-10, DeVita 4-1-9, Reigelman 9-3-21, Hatch 4-2-11, Cennitani 4-0-11, Atkins 5-0-10, Darnos 3-2-8, Coehring 3-0-6, Rieth 2-0-5, Vasiliou 1-0-2. Totals 38-11-93.

Cle. Christian	7	7	7	20	—	41
Brookside	23	26	22	22	—	93

Three-point goals: (CCA) Perkins 2, DeJesus

Pycraft, Logan capture titles at Southview

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — There were two area champions at the fifth annual Southview Holiday Wrestling Tournament Saturday.

Seniors Jim Pycraft of Keystone and Brian Logan of Columbia captured titles at the yearly event sponsored by the Sports Health/Cleveland Clinic.

How much does Pycraft love the Southview Holiday Wrestling Tournament? The senior two-time state placer won Southview title number three, having won a "B" Tournament crown as a freshman. He's this year's Most Valuable Wrestler.

Pycraft was dominant and unchallenged, posting five falls and a 14-4 major decision over Jake Kroon Van Diest of Beaver Valley in the finals, upping his season mark to 8-0. Pycraft had fall times of 4:42, 2:43, 3:05, 1:45 and 2:55.

Pycraft won his third title on the strength of seven takedowns.

"I'm more comfortable on my feet and that's what I'm best at," said Pycraft. "I really wanted to step it up a notch here because I missed our first tournament because I was taking my ACT's."

"I was a little jittery tonight because he (Van Diest) was strong. So I just took it slow. This has been my best tournament through the years. I've really enjoyed wrestling here."

Logan was the 215-pound runner-up here last year, losing in overtime. This outing, he took it all with a pin at the 5:21 mark against Austin Balogh of Clyde.

"It was nice breaking a sweat," quipped Logan, who earned his fourth pin of the tourney. "I knew if I could win this tournament it would boost my confidence. This is just what I needed right here."

Logan remains unbeaten at 10-0.

In what was definitely the high-light match of the evening, it appeared Southview senior state placer Hector Mendez scored a thrilling 11-9 come-from-behind

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overtime victory over Bobby Blackburn of Clyde, claiming the 125-pound championship.

However, it was later determined that on one occasion Blackburn was awarded only two back points when he should have been awarded three because the match was stopped for blood time.

This is how the match progressed. Thirty seconds into the match, Blackburn's head connect-ed with Mendez' shoulder, sending the Saint standout reeling. Blackburn hit a pair of headlocks in between blood timeouts, giving him a 6-0 lead. But it should have been a 7-0 lead as one of the near-fall counts should have resulted in three back points, not two. A Mendez escape ended the first period scoring.

Mendez kicked Blackburn out and then hit a takedown for a 7-3 score after two. A Mendez reversal in the third narrowed the gap to 7-5. Mendez let Blackburn up two more times and then, executing takedowns with 55 seconds and 13 seconds left in regulation time, tied the match at 9-all. Twenty-seven seconds into overtime, Mendez scored what was thought to be the winning takedown and the huge partisan Southview crowd began to celebrate.

Later, the outcome was reversed with Blackburn winning 10-9.

Before learning the outcome had been reversed, Mendez said, "In the beginning, he (Blackburn) got me. He busted my nose. But this is my senior year. I can't lose here with everybody cheering for me. I couldn't let everyone down. My nose is killing me but I couldn't feel it at the end. This is such a special feeling. I wouldn't trade it for anything."

But Mendez had to trade it for second place.

After learning of the change, Mendez said, "Did anyone see that match?...They can't take that

away from me."

It was the first loss in 15 matches for Mendez.

Columbia sophomore Mike Hammon had quite a tournament, earning runner-up honors at 135 pounds. The 9-2 Raider had four falls and a 4-2 win before meeting Beaver Local senior Cole Bowersock. Bowersock prevailed 17-4.

Clyde, fourth in Division II in Columbus last March, easily defended its Southview championship of three years standing, amassing 375 points, a 54-point advantage over runner-up Beaver Local. The Fliers sent seven to the championship mat, resulting in three championships. Southview won the initial tournament in 1996. Clyde has owned it ever since.

Locally, Southview's 273 points gave them a third-place showing, tied with Holy Name, the highest among area entries. The Saints were runners-up the past two years.

Keystone finished seventh and Columbia eighth.

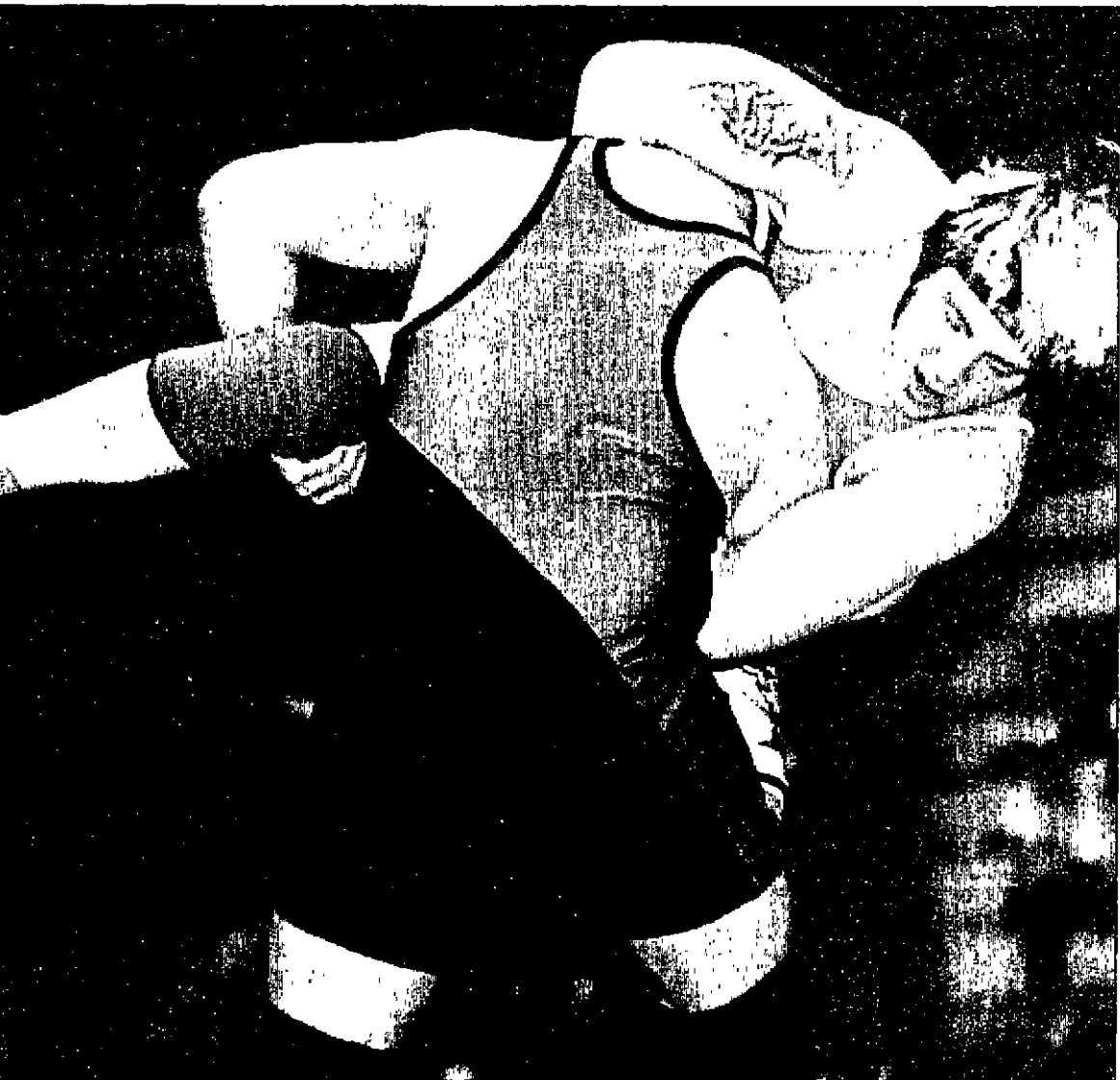
"I'm happy with placing nine but I would have liked to have more kids in the top three or four," said veteran Southview coach Dan Ternes. "It's been a good tournament. We've had the largest crowds we've ever had. There were a lot of close matches. We lost some close matches ourselves."

One of those matches pitted Southview senior Carl Harris against Chris Smith of Copley in a 152-pound semifinal. Smith won an 8-7 squeaker.

"That match could have gone either way," Ternes said. "Carl wrestled real hard. But he came back nicely."

Harris pinned in the consolation semifinals and scored a big 10-0 decision for a third-place finish.

Thirty-one other area wrestlers reached the "A" tournament following Friday's round-robin action.



GREG RUFFING / CHRONICLE

UPLIFTING EXPERIENCE: Ben Logan of Columbia, who went on to win the 215-pound championship in a later match, lifts Moe Bryner of Southview off the mat during the Southview Holiday Wrestling Tournament.

Twenty-five recovered to take tournament placements after falling in the preliminary or semifinal rounds.

The host Saints placed nine, Avon Lake seven, and Elyria, Keystone and Columbia four apiece.

Alec Bottomlee secured Elyria's highest finish, a third at 125 pounds.

Final Team Standings
Clyde 375, Beaver Local 321, Iie Southview and Holy Name 273, Lakota 270, Copley 250, Keystone 226.5, Columbia 222, Buckeye Valley 185, Avon Lake 169.5, Notre Dame 155.5, Elyria 150, Akron Firestone 140, Euclid 130, Jefferson Area 110, Trinity 50.

Championship Results
103 - Hersault (NDC) by disq over Wilson (AF)
Third Ysaura (CL) tech fall Brown (SV) 19-4, Fifth: Burren (KEY) dec. Smith (BL) 2-1 o.t.; 112 - T. Shearer (CL) by injury default over Hoffman (CLX), Third: Olom (LAK) dec. Sheehan (HN) 6-4, Fifth: Fucker (EL) by forfeit, 119 - N. Shearer (CL) dec. Emminger (BL) 12-4, Third: Bernath (KEY) dec. Sines (LAK) 17-5, Fifth: Heidelberg (SV) pin Janusz (NDC) 4-20.
125 Bottomlee (EL) dec. Mendez (SV) 10-9, Fifth: Priddy (KEY) dec. Early (EL) 6-4, 130 - Bloom (LAK) dec. Hayden (CP) 11-6, Third: Wade (SV) pin Davis (AV) 2-33, Fifth: Anthony (COL) dec. Rice (HN) 8-3, 135 - Bowersock (BL) dec. dec. M. Hammon 17-4, Third:

Bens (AF) dec. B. Felton (EL) 4-3, Fifth: Knox (AL) dec. Nicholas (HN) 7-4, 140 - Tuttle (CP) pin Brand (JA) 1-34, Third: J. Hammon (COL) dec. Parsons (BL) 9-4, Fifth: Wolf (SV) dec. West (AF) 14-4,
145 - Long (CP) dec. Westhoven (HN) 6-4, Third: Hogan (AL) dec. Smith (BL) 10-4, Fifth: Berntsen (SV) dec. Judy (NDC) 3-2, 152 - Smith (CP) dec. Brand (LAK) 6-5, Third: Harris (SV) dec. Mann (AL) 10-0, Fifth: Rogers (CL) dec. Knowlton (EL) 17-7, 160 - Pyranth (KEY) dec. Dietl (BY) 14-4, Third: Moore (BL) dec. White (AF) 12-2, Fifth: Urbanski (CP) dec. Webster (EU) 4-2, 171 - Williams (BL) pin Dymond (EL) 5-54 Third: D'Amico (EU) dec. Behm (AL) 11-1, Fifth: Jacobs (LAK) dec. Sanaak (CP) 11-1.

189 - Pamst (BV) pin Gavak (HN) 11-26, Third: Williams (BL) dec. Powers (LAK) 3-2, Fifth: Cortes (SVX) by forfeit over Ott (CL), 215 - Logan (COL) pin Balogh (CL) 5-21, Third: Hoppel (BL) dec. Turski (HN), 8-3, Fifth: Bryner (SV) dec. Mikalac (JA) 2-0, 275 - Bucha (HN) dec. Seal (CL) 2-0 o.t., Third: Wilson (AV) dec. Flagdale (AF) 4-3, Fifth: Lightfoot (AL) dec. Hebble (KEY) 5-3.

Late shot lifts Keystone

HENRIETTA TWP. — Cassie Banks scored the game-winning basket with 3.3 seconds left as Keystone beat Firelands 41-39 in a Lorain County Conference game Saturday.

The victory kept Keystone (6-1, 4-1 LCC) in a tie with Midview for second place in the conference. Firelands is winless through nine games.

Brandy Terry led Keystone with 14 points. Katie Jesko scored 12 points and snagged 13 rebounds for Firelands.

KEYSTONE (41): Shaw 0-2-2, A. Terry 3-1-7, B. Terry 5-1-14, Bologan 2-1-5, Johnson 1-2-4, Kay 1-2-4, Banks 2-1-5, Riley 0-0-0. Totals 16-13-41.
FIRELANDS (39): Matus 2-4-8, Davis 2-2-8, Pivinski 4-1-9, Jesko 5-2-12, Caywood 2-0-4, Davies 0-0-0. Totals 15-9-39.

Keystone	11	10	13	7	—	41
Firelands	7	9	12	11	—	39

Three-point goals: None

Avon 40, Clearview 26

SHEFFIELD TWP. — Avon remained in first place with an easy victory over Clearview in LCC play.

Rachel Smitek scored 19 points for Avon (7-2, 5-0 LCC). Lavonne

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Davis had 18 for Clearview (2-9, 2-3 LCC).

AVON (40): Smitek 7-5-19, Guerrieri 1-0-2, Grawner 1-1-3, Hricovcic 6-0-12, Burge 2-0-4. Totals 17-9-40.
CLEARVIEW (26): Earl 0-2-2, Taylor 0-3-3, Simmons 1-1-3, Davis 9-0-18, Nickoloff 0-0-0. Totals 10-6-26.

Avon	7	14	9	10	—	40
Clearview	5	8	5	8	—	26

Three-point goals: None

Midview 56, Wellington 46

WELLINGTON — Adrian Semaru and Courtney Gilbert scored 16 points each as Midview overpowered Wellington in the second half in an LCC game.

Lisa Dominguez added 11 points for Midview (5-5, 4-1 LCC). Michele Jordan and Lucille Huelsman scored 11 points each for Wellington (3-6, 1-4 LCC).

MIDVIEW (56): Dominguez 4-3-11, Gilbert 5-4-18, Leslie 1-0-2, Orr 2-0-4, Semaru 6-4-18, Arbo 0-0-0, Burnside 1-0-2, Seroka 1-1-3, Vavzincak 1-0-2. Totals 21-14-56.
WELLINGTON (46): Jordan 3-5-11, Huelsman 4-3-11, Hamilton 4-0-5, Kohler 1-3-5, Casselberry 1-2-4, Delymba 0-2-2, Hannon 1-0-2, Bril 1-0-2. Totals 15-14-46.

Midview	13	14	10	19	—	56
Wellington	11	14	4	17	—	46

Three-point goals: Wellington (Hamilton)
Junior varsity: Midview 36, Wellington 19

Brookside 75, Oberlin 66

OBERLIN — Brookside opened a big lead early, then held off an Oberlin charge to earn a Lorain County Conference win.

The Cardinals led by 11 after the first quarter but saw Oberlin cut the lead to one point at half-time.

Alesia Cabbil and Kara Giusti each had 15 points and 13 rebounds to lead the Cardinals (4-5, 2-3).

Lucrezia Baker scored 24 — including four 3-pointers — to pace Oberlin (4-5, 2-3). Marquita Jones added 16 points for the Indians.

BROOKSIDE (75): Darnos 5-2-13, Hense 3-3-9, King 1-0-2, Cabbil 6-1-15, Engle 3-2-9, Giusti 6-3-15, Turman 1-2-4, Liszak 4-0-8. Totals 29-13-75.
OBERLIN (66): Halstrom 1-2-4, Baker 10-0-24, Witherspoon 0-4-4, Walker 1-2-4, Gregory 3-1-7, Jones 8-0-18, Adams 2-3-7. Totals 25-12-66.

Brookside	17	10	22	26	—	75
Oberlin	6	20	19	21	—	66

Three-point goals: (B) Cabbil 2, Darnos, Engle, (O) Baker 4.

Junior varsity: Oberlin 46-43

Spartans jolt Panthers

Paul Heyse

The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA - Adrienne Costello's high school graduation won't come soon enough for Elyria Catholic basketball fans.

For the second straight meeting, the Lorain Catholic senior guard beat the Spartans' rivals with a 3-point basket. The 5-foot-6 Costello buried a trey with 42 seconds left Saturday to lift the Spartans to a 41-39 victory at EC.

Lorain Catholic (5-4 overall) entered the contest with a four-game losing slide. On the plus side, however, LC entered with a 13-game winning streak against Elyria Catholic (6-4) spanning the last eight seasons.

The Spartans hadn't lost to the Panthers since dropping two to EC in the 1991-92 season — current coach Anjie Chet's freshman year.

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Costello, who finished with 12 points, scored seven of her team's final eight points. Lorain Catholic overcame a 39-31 deficit while holding the Panthers scoreless the final 4:25 of the game.

LC outscored the Panthers 10-0 over that span to steal the win.

"I was hot and I could feel it. I told myself, 'I'm going to hit this,'" Costello said of her game-winner. "(Chet) told us to give the ball to whoever is on. Give them the ball. I felt it. I knew it was going to go in because I had hit a couple of other shots."

Costello's 3-point basket was the Spartans' third straight conversion off an EC turnover. "She looked at me right

before she took the shot and said to me, 'Let me shoot it,'" Chet said. "I didn't say anything. She turned and shot it. When she shot it, I knew it was going in."

"I don't know what it was, but she was doing it. Adrienne was big for us."

Senior guard Amy Esser padded LC's lead as she hit the front end of a 1-and-1 with 18 seconds left.